

Given the length of the book, here is the panel-by-panel transcript for the opening sequence which sets the stage for the Roman occupation and introduces Asterix.

Asterix the Gaul (Book 1)

Page 1: Title Page

- **Text:** HODDER DARGAUD PRESENTS. BOOK 1.
- **Credits:** TEXT: GOSCINNY. DRAWINGS: UDERZO.
- **Main Title:** Asterix the Gaul.
- **Visual:** Asterix stands proudly in the center, flanked by various Gaulish and Roman characters.

Page 2: Introduction

Panel 1

- **Caption:** In the year 50 BC, after a long struggle, the ancient Gauls had been conquered by the Romans...

Panel 2

- **Caption:** Chiefs like Vercingetorix had to lay their arms at Caesar's feet...
- **Visual:** Vercingetorix drops a massive pile of weapons directly onto Julius Caesar's feet.
- **Caesar:** OUGH!

Panel 3

- **Caption:** Peace reigns, disturbed only by occasional attacks by the Germans, speedily repulsed...
- **German Soldier:** Gut! Ve go!
- **Gaulish Soldier:** \$o! But ve komm back!

Panel 4

- **Caption:** All Gaul is occupied...
- **Visual:** A map of Gaul showing various regions (Belgica, Celtica, Aquitania) under Roman control.
- **Caption 2:** All? No—one village still holds out stubbornly against the invaders. One small village surrounded by fortified Roman camps...

Panel 5

- **Visual:** Close-up of the map showing the village in Armorica surrounded by four camps: Totorum, Aquarium, Laudanum, and Compendium.

Panel 6

- **Caption:** And now we meet our hero, the warrior Asterix, just off hunting as usual.
- **Visual:** Asterix walks through the forest with his sword.

Panel 7

- **Caption:** Accidence will happen...
- **Visual:** Asterix bumps into a Roman patrol.
- **SFX:** BIFF! BANG! CLANG!

Page 3: The Roman Problem

Panel 1

- **Visual:** Inside the fortified camp of Totorum.
- **Roman Centurion (Crismus Bonus):** I've had enough! Those Gauls make us look like fools!

Panel 2

- **Bonus:** Every time we send a patrol, they come back in bandages! Look at them!
- **Visual:** A line of battered, bruised Roman soldiers limps past.

Panel 3

- **Bonus:** Marcus Sacapus!
- **Sacapus:** Yes, Centurion?
- **Bonus:** We must find out the secret of their strength. They aren't normal men!

Panel 4

- **Sacapus:** But how, O Centurion?
- **Bonus:** We need a spy. Someone to infiltrate the village.

Page 4: The Infiltration Plan

Panel 1

- **Visual:** The Romans are drawing lots.
- **Sacapus:** The short straw loses.

Panel 2

- **Visual:** A skinny, nervous legionary named Caligula Minus draws the short straw.
- **Caligula Minus:** Oh, no... not me. I'm a coward!

Panel 3

- **Sacapus:** You'll be a great hero, Caligula Minus! We'll dress you as a Gaul.
- **Bonus:** You will find out what makes them so strong.

Panel 4

- **Visual:** The Romans are disguising Caligula. They give him a mustache and Gaulish clothes.
- **Bonus:** Your name is now Caliguliminix. You are a traveler from Lutetia.

Page 5: Asterix and the Roman Spy

Panel 1

- **Visual:** Asterix is in the forest again, carrying a wild boar.
- **Asterix:** A nice boar for dinner.

Panel 2

- **Visual:** He spots "Caliguliminix" being "chased" by Romans (a staged act to make him look like a victim).
- **Caligula Minus:** Help! Save me from these Romans!

Panel 3

- **Visual:** Asterix drops the boar and attacks the Romans.
- **SFX:** WHAM! POW!
- **Asterix:** Leave him alone, you bullies!

Panel 4

- **Asterix:** Are you alright, friend?
- **Caligula Minus (shaking):** Y-yes... thank you, brave Gaul. I am Caliguliminix.

Panel 5

- **Asterix:** Come back to our village. You look like you need a good meal!

Page 6

Panel 1

- **Caption:** Meanwhile, at the Roman camp of Compendium, in the tent of Centurion Crismus Bonus...
- **Roman Guard:** Ave Crismus Bonus! The patrol's back!
- **Crismus Bonus:** Ave Julius Pompos! I'll go and inspect them.

Panel 2

- **Bonus:** What happened, by all the gods? Were you attacked by superior numbers?
- **Injured Roman:** Oh yes!

Panel 3

- **Injured Roman:** Superior numbers... can't quite say... there was one of them... not a very large one either!
- **Bonus:** By Jupiter!

Panel 4

- **Bonus:** There must be some secret behind the superhuman strength of these Gauls!

Panel 5

- **Caption:** Meanwhile....
- **Obelix:** So you're back, Asterix. Anything interesting happen?
- **Asterix:** Knocked four Romans out. Want to help me eat my boar?

Panel 6

- **Obelix:** Oh, good! I've got two more menhirs to deliver... no... I'm coming!

Panel 7

- **Asterix:** Come in, Obelix. It's done to a turn!
- **Obelix:** Yum, yum, Asterix!

Page 7

Panel 1

- **Asterix:** The Romans won't like this. They'll launch a new offensive....
- **Obelix:** Huh!

Panel 2

- **Asterix:** So long as our Druid Getafix keeps brewing his magic potion, the Romans can't do a thing. Let's go and see the Druid now!

Panel 3

- **Asterix:** Getafix! O Druid!
- **Obelix:** He'll be up that tree, cutting mistletoe with his golden sickle.

Panel 4

- **Asterix:** The time has come for me to have my dose of potion....
- **Getafix:** Oh, all right... come home with me.....
- **SFX:** CHIC! TCHAC!

Panel 5

- **Getafix:** You made me jump! I've gone and cut myself with my sickle!
- **Asterix:** Sorry....

Panel 6

- **Getafix:** Here is the potion that makes the drinker invincible! It increases his strength tenfold—for a limited period of time.

Panel 7

- **Asterix:** What's the recipe, O Druid?
- **Getafix:** The origin of this recipe is lost in the mists of time. It is handed down from Druid to Druid by word of mouth....

Panel 8

- **Getafix:** All I can reveal is that there's mistletoe and lobster in it.... The lobster is optional, but it improves the flavour!

Page 8

Panel 1

- **Obelix:** Can I have some?
- **Getafix:** No, Obelix, you can not—and well you know it!

Panel 2

- **Getafix:** You fell into the cauldron when you were a baby, and it had a permanent effect on you. It would be dangerous for you to drink any more!

Panel 3

- **Visual:** Asterix drinks the potion from a small cup.
- **SFX:** SPLOSH!
- **Asterix:** Thanks, O Druid!
- **Obelix:** It's not fair, by Belenos!

Panel 4

- **Visual:** Asterix shakes the Druid's hand, unintentionally hurting him due to his newfound strength.
- **Getafix:** OW! OW! OW! I've told you before not to shake hands with me when you've just had your potion!
- **Asterix:** He's right, I don't know my own strength!

Page 9

Panel 1

- **Visual:** Back at the Roman camp.
- **Bonus:** We've been laying siege to these Gauls for years! They've got a nerve! This morning's provocation is going too far.

Panel 2

- **Bonus:** One against four is no joke! They're making us look ridiculous. There's some mystery behind the strength of these Gauls.

Panel 3

- **Bonus:** We must learn their secret!
- **Marcus Ginantonicus:** You're right, Marcus Ginantonicus! We must learn their secret, and fast!

Panel 4

- **Bonus:** Caesar has indicated his displeasure all the way from Rome. We need a spy in the Gauls' village. I want a volunteer!
- **Legionaries:** ?!

Panel 5

- **Bonus:** As there are so many volunteers, we'll have to play musical chairs to pick the spy!

Panel 6

- **Caption:** This ancient Roman game is played with one less chair than there are legionaries..... when the music stops..... all the players sit down.

Panel 7

- **Sacapus:** The legionary without a chair has lost. Caligula Minus is out!
- **Caligula Minus:** I'm not going to spy on the Gauls!

Panel 8

- **Bonus:** I'll roast you alive if you don't!
- **Caligula Minus:** Oh, all right, I'll go and spy on the Gauls, Chief!

Page 10

Panel 1

- **Bonus:** Caesar will be eternally grateful to you if you go, Caligula Minus! Get him up like a Gaul!

Panel 2

- **Caption:** Meanwhile, in the Gaulish village...
- **Vitalstatistix:** Those Romans have kept quiet too long! It can't last. Be on your guard—and never forget to take your magic potion!
- **Villagers:** Long live our chief Vitalstatistix!

Panel 3

- **Obelix:** They won't let me have any potion. It's not fair! I feel rather weak... help!
- **Asterix:** What is it, Obelix?

Panel 4

- **Visual:** The bard Cacophonix approaches with his lyre.
- **Cacophonix:** I will now give you a song to inspire the warriors with courage...
- **Obelix:** Can't stop... I've got no end of menhairs to deliver..
- **Asterix:** It's getting late.

Panel 5

- **Cacophonix:** Barbarians! They don't appreciate my art!

Panel 6

- **Visual:** Back at the Roman camp, Caligula Minus is in costume.
- **Sacapus:** Caligula Minus is ready, Crismus Bonus, we've disguised him as a Gaul.
- **Bonus:** Lets have a look...
- **Legionaries:** HA! HA! HO! HO!

Page 11

Panel 1

- **Bonus:** Put him in chains.
- **Caligula Minus:** HA! HA! WHASSUP?

Panel 2

- **Bonus:** We're going to take you for a little walk near the Gaulish village. When the Gauls see you they'll come out and rescue you.

Panel 3

- **Bonus:** Then you'll be able to infiltrate the village and learn their secret.... That's my plan.

Panel 4

- **Bonus:** Well, what do you think?
- **Caligula Minus:** I don't. I didn't understand a word of it.
- **Bonus:** Take him away!

Panel 5

- **Caligula Minus:** OUCH! CAREFUL! I'M A ROMAN! I'M ONLY A PRETEND GAUL!

Page 12

Panel 1

- **Caption:** Soon afterwards...
- **Caligula Minus:** Is this walk going on much longer?
- **Roman Guard:** Shut up, Caligula Minus!

Panel 2

- **Caption:** And not far away...
- **Obelix:** I could just do with a nice fight...
- **Asterix:** Can't count on it—the Romans are getting cautious after all those knocks on the head...

Panel 3

- **Asterix:** Wait a minute! SSH!
- **Obelix:** HM?

Panel 4

- **Asterix:** Let's hide at the top of this tree! We may soon be loosening up our muscles!

Panel 5

- **Caligula Minus:** By all the gods, I should have stayed at home! I never ought to have joined Caesar's legions in search of fame and fortune!

Panel 6

- **Caligula Minus:** My skin's not worth a sesterlius and I'll never eat tapioca (1) like mother made again!
- **Footnote:** (1) Spaghetti was not imported from China by Marco Polo until much later.

Panel 7

- **Roman Guard:** Will you shut up, Caligula Minus! After all, when the hordes of Gauls attack us you're the only one they'll spare!

Panel 8

- **Asterix:** Sure enough, there are the hordes... Romans, with a Gaul as prisoner! We'll rescue him!

Page 13

Panel 1

- **Asterix:** Right! Everyone got it?
- **Roman Guard (thinking):** If they attack we only put up a token resistance!

Panel 2

- **Asterix:** Here we come, by Toutatis!
- **Roman Guard:** Here they come, by Jupiter!

Panel 3

- **Visual:** Asterix and Obelix attack the Romans.
- **Asterix:** They're a bit soft today, don't you think?
- **Obelix:** Yes, they're off form. They should take care of themselves—eat a well balanced diet.
- **SFX:** PAF!

Panel 4

- **Obelix:** That's the lot... couldn't we bring them round and start again?
- **Asterix:** No, come on! It's getting late.
- **SFX:** CLONG!

Panel 5

- **Asterix:** Mission accomplished! We will strike off your chains! But you'll need tools.... A hammer!
- **Obelix:** HA! HA! We're the tools!

Panel 6

- **Asterix:** What's your name?
- **Caligula Minus:** Calig...er...Caliguliminix. I'm from Lutetia. I was just going on holiday to Armorica when the Romans captured me.

Panel 7

- **Asterix:** But everywhere...
- **Caligula Minus:** Yes, but I look so clever and cunning that in their eyes I was a spy.
- **Obelix:** The Romans and the Gauls are at peace!

Panel 8

- **Asterix:** Their eyes can't be all that bright! HA! HA!